Netflix Music: Project Visuals

Charts, personas, journey maps, frameworks and roadmap for the Netflix Music launch

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The art of why: five questions lead to Netflix's one unfair advantage

Asking 'why' until the answer is something only Netflix can do

WHY 1

Why build a music app at all?

To earn from members' listening hours, which Netflix monetizes at zero today, and to keep them subscribed.

WHY 2

Why would anyone leave Spotify for it?

Only if Netflix solves a problem that existing apps leave unsolved.

WHY 3

Why aren't existing apps solving it?

They don't know what you watch: discovery is generic (4 of 10 users) and exclusives are thin (3 of 10).

WHY 4

Why does that gap matter to users?

Fans want a show to continue in their ears; casual listeners want the right music with zero effort.

WHY 5

Why can Netflix close it?

It owns the shows, the soundtracks and the viewing data. That is the root advantage the MVP is built on.

Source: report analysis

Problem definition: no app connects what people watch with what they hear

Problem statement built from the customer research

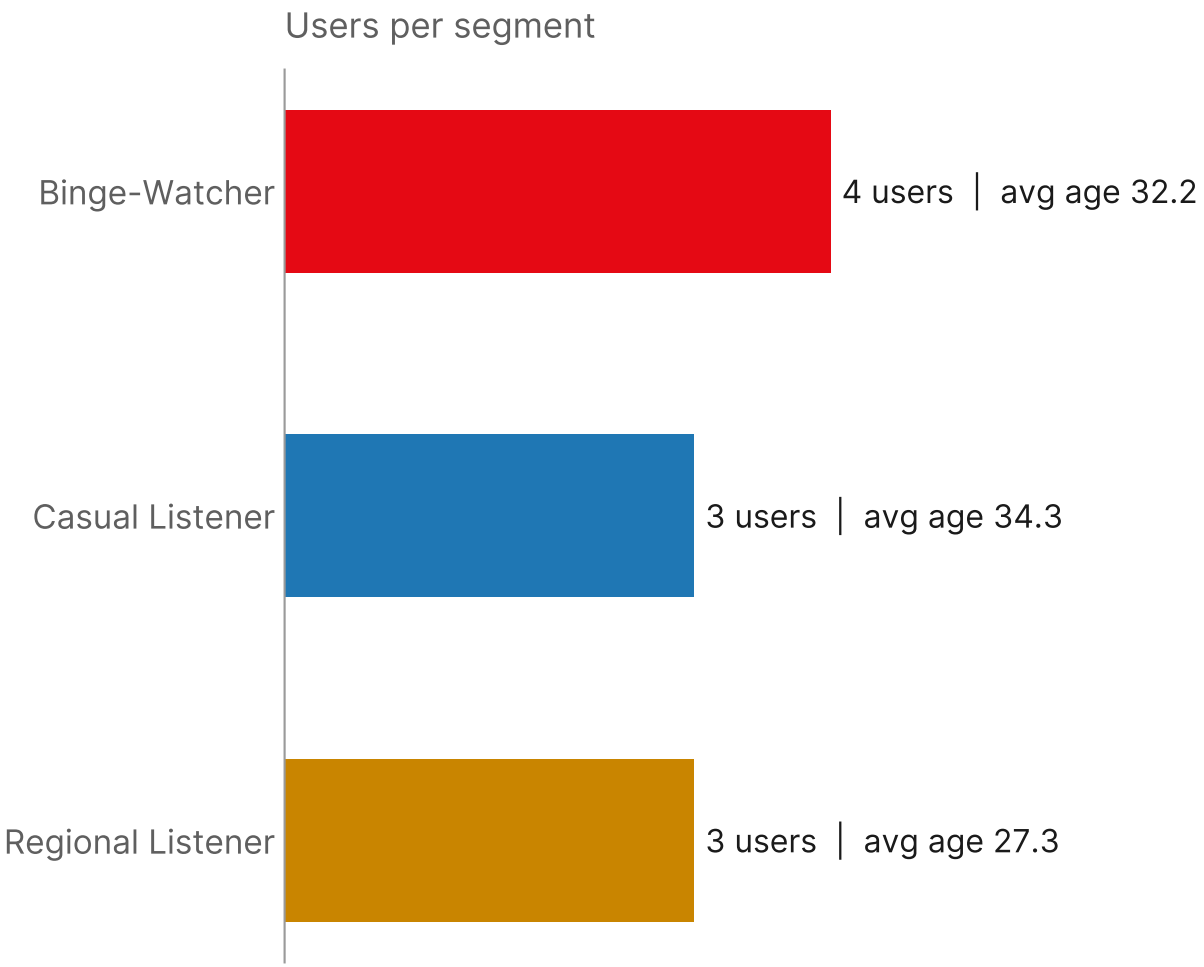
WHO	Netflix members aged 22-45 who also stream music; Binge-Watchers first
PROBLEM	They can't easily find music and audio that fits their taste, mood and the shows they love. No app connects what they watch with what they hear.
EVIDENCE	4 of 10 users report a discovery or personalization pain; 3 of 10 report missing exclusive, regional or language content; Engagement is the weakest journey stage for all 3 segments.
WHY IT MATTERS (USER)	Time lost scrolling; the story ends at the credits; local culture is buried.
WHY IT MATTERS (NETFLIX)	Listening hours earn nothing today; a second daily habit lowers churn.

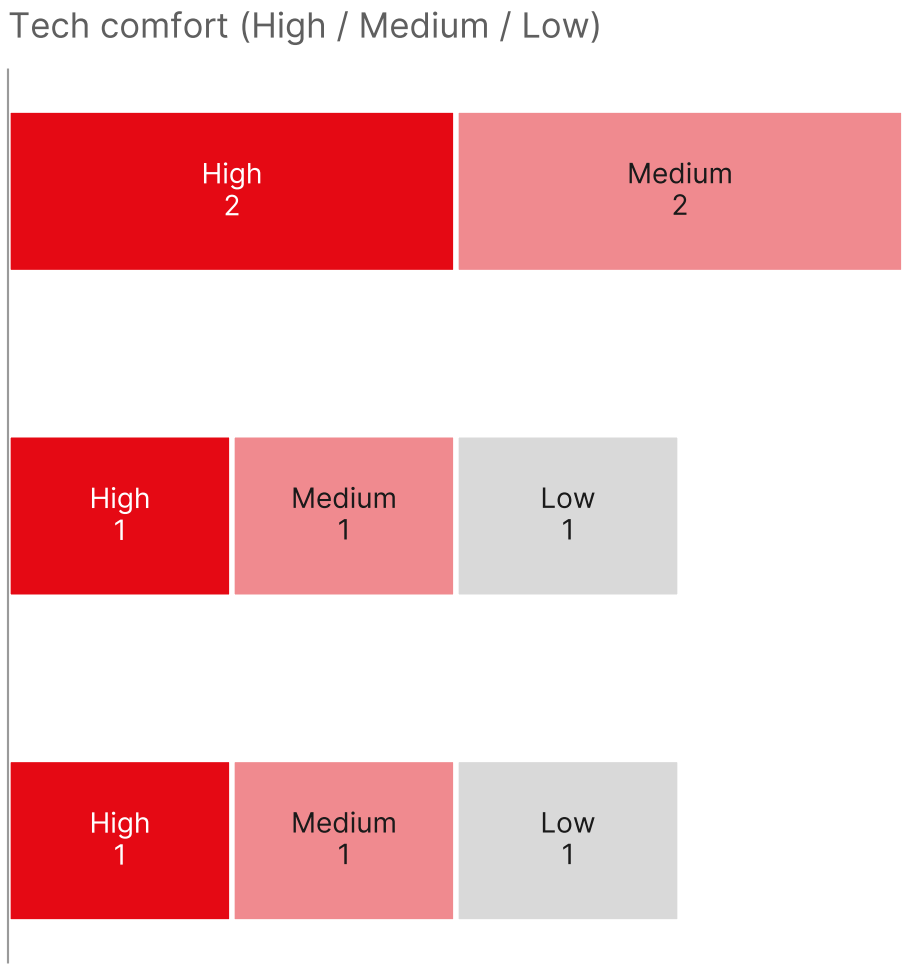
HOW MIGHT WE **How might we turn what members watch into what they love to listen to?**

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Binge-Watchers are the largest and most tech-comfortable segment

Users per segment and their tech comfort level (10 users)

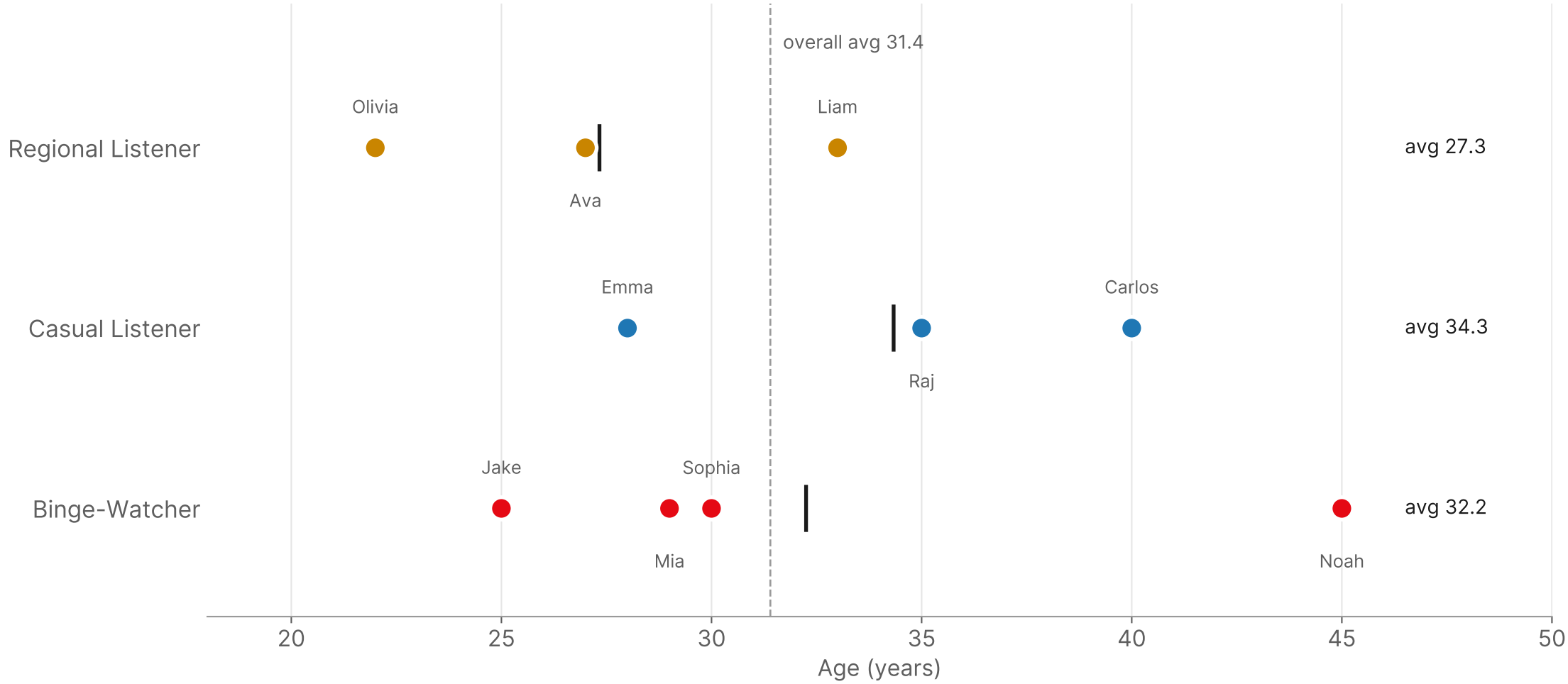




Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

The core audience is 22 to 45; Regional Listeners are the youngest

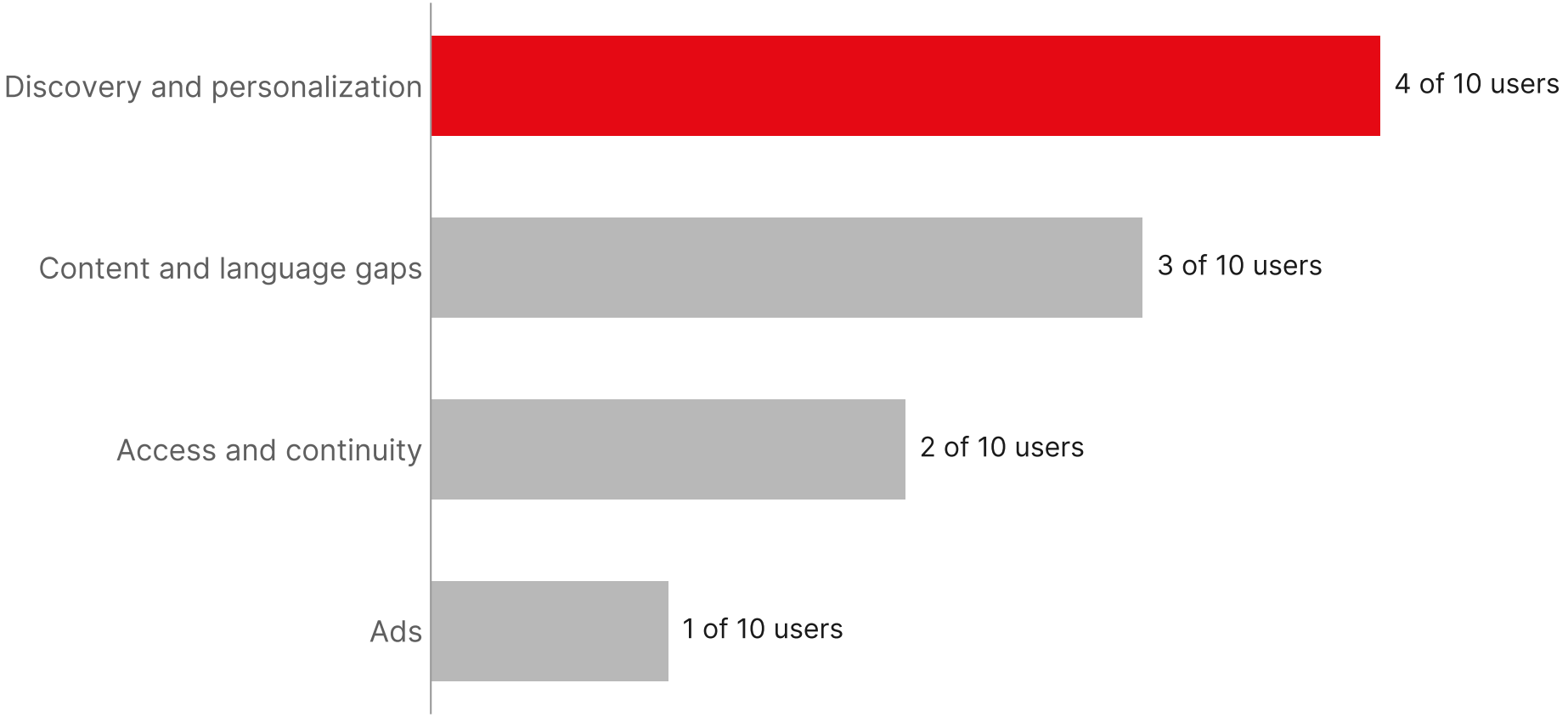
Each dot is one user; short bar = segment average, dashed line = overall average



Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Discovery is the most common pain point (4 of 10 users)

Users per pain-point theme; each user's pain point is assigned to one theme



Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Exclusive content and a better experience drive payment equally

Users per purchase-motivation theme; exclusives and experience tie at 4 each



Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Persona: Jake the Binge-Watcher

Built from Jake Thompson, Sophia Lee, Noah Brown, Mia Johnson

J

Jake the Binge-Watcher

Binge-Watcher

Age 25-45
Tech comfort: medium to high

"When I finish a season I want the soundtrack and the cast's stories right there."

Quote is illustrative

LISTENS TO

Soundtracks, movie scores, Netflix podcasts, K-Pop, Hip-Hop

GOALS

Stay in a show's world after the episode ends; hear exclusive behind-the-scenes audio

FEATURES WANTED

AI playlists, behind-the-scenes content, karaoke mode, high-quality streaming

PAIN POINTS

Limited exclusive content, too many ads, few language options, weak personalization

WOULD PAY FOR

Exclusive Netflix content, ad-free, interactive features, best audio quality

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Persona: Emma the Casual Listener

Built from Raj Patel, Emma Wilson, Carlos Gomez



Emma the Casual Listener

Casual Listener

Age 28-40
Tech comfort: high to low

"I just want something calm for work without scrolling for ten minutes."

Quote is illustrative

LISTENS TO

Top charts, pop, Lo-Fi and chill, classic rock, 80s hits

GOALS

Get the right music for the moment with no effort

FEATURES WANTED

Personalized playlists, mood-based playlists, offline listening

PAIN POINTS

Hard-to-navigate UI, no mood playlists, limited offline access

WOULD PAY FOR

Better discovery, relaxing music for work, seamless offline mode

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Persona: Olivia the Regional Listener

Built from Olivia Chen, Liam Davis, Ava Martinez



Olivia the Regional Listener

Regional Listener

Age 22-33
Tech comfort: high to low

"Global apps bury the music from my own region."

Quote is illustrative

LISTENS TO

Local folk and indie, regional-language podcasts, Latin hits, reggaeton

GOALS

Discover local artists and podcasts in their own language

FEATURES WANTED

Regional content discovery, voice search for podcasts, cultural playlists

PAIN POINTS

Not enough regional music, hard to find podcasts, no multi-device sync

WOULD PAY FOR

Access to local music, more language support, curated global music

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Jobs to be done: each segment hires the app for a different job

When I … I want to … so I can … (from user motivations and journeys)

Binge-Watcher

WHEN I

finish an episode

I WANT TO

keep living in that show's world

SO I CAN

stay connected to the story and its characters

Casual Listener

WHEN I

am working or relaxing

I WANT TO

get the right music instantly

SO I CAN

focus or unwind without effort

Regional Listener

WHEN I

want music from my culture

I WANT TO

find local artists and podcasts in my language

SO I CAN

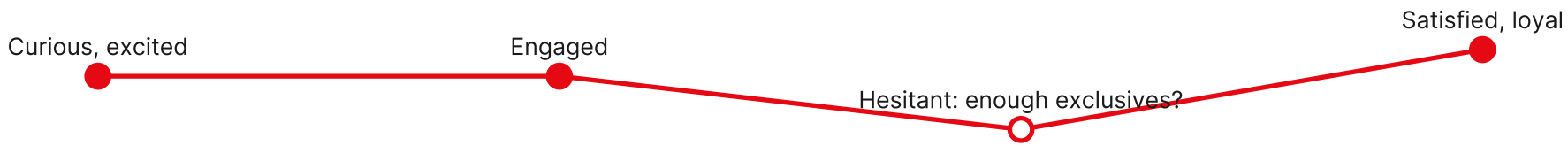
feel represented, not buried under global hits

Source: report analysis

Journey map: Jake the Binge-Watcher

Touchpoints, emotions, pain points and opportunities inferred from the customer research

	Discovery	Engagement	Subscription decision	Usage experience
Behaviour	Sees Netflix promoting music playlists based on watched series.	Explores soundtracks and exclusive audio related to favorite shows.	Decides between free and premium plan based on content exclusivity.	Enjoys AI-curated playlists and behind-the-scenes music.
Touchpoint	Netflix home screen, end-of-episode card	Show page, soundtrack hub	Paywall, plan comparison	Daily mixes, new-episode alerts
Emotion	Curious, excited	Engaged	Hesitant: enough exclusives?	Satisfied, loyal
Pain point	Promo can feel like an ad	Limited exclusives; ads break immersion	Premium value unclear	Weak personalization; few languages
Opportunity	'Listen' button after the credits	Show hubs: scores, commentaries, cast podcasts	Bundle with Netflix plan; trial of exclusives	Watch-history playlists; karaoke mode



Emotion: filled dot = positive, open dot = negative.

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Journey map: Emma the Casual Listener

Touchpoints, emotions, pain points and opportunities inferred from the customer research

	Discovery	Engagement	Subscription decision	Usage experience
Behaviour	Finds Netflix Music through social media ads or word-of-mouth.	Checks trending playlists and explores different genres.	Chooses free plan but is intrigued by premium recommendations.	Listens occasionally, mainly for relaxation or while working.
Touchpoint	Social ad, friend's shared link	Home feed, charts, genre pages	Upgrade prompt	Mood playlists, offline downloads
Emotion	Mildly interested	Overwhelmed by choice	Unconvinced	Content, not attached
Pain point	No reason to switch apps	Hard navigation; no mood playlists	Premium value not felt on free	Limited offline; weak habit
Opportunity	Shareable Netflix-branded playlists	One-tap mood tiles on a simple home	One-week taste of premium recs	Smart offline auto-download

Emotion: filled dot = positive, open dot = negative.

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Journey map: Olivia the Regional Listener

Touchpoints, emotions, pain points and opportunities inferred from the customer research

	Discovery	Engagement	Subscription decision	Usage experience
Behaviour	Hears about Netflix Music from regional social media influencers.	Searches for local language music and culturally relevant playlists.	Subscribes after finding exclusive regional content.	Uses Netflix Music daily for discovering regional artists.
Touchpoint	Regional influencer posts	Search, language filters	Paywall after regional content	Artist pages, phone and TV
Emotion	Hopeful	Frustrated by global results	Convinced once found	Engaged advocate
Pain point	Few regional ambassadors	Not enough regional music; podcasts hard to find	Thin regional exclusives at launch	No multi-device sync; few languages
Opportunity	Influencer and local-artist partnerships	Regional home, local-language voice search	Soundtracks from regional Originals	Cross-device sync; artist spotlights

Emotion: filled dot = positive, open dot = negative.

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Engagement is where all three journeys are at risk

Cross-journey insights from the three journey maps

1. Engagement is the shared weak stage: discovery quality decides who reaches the paywall.

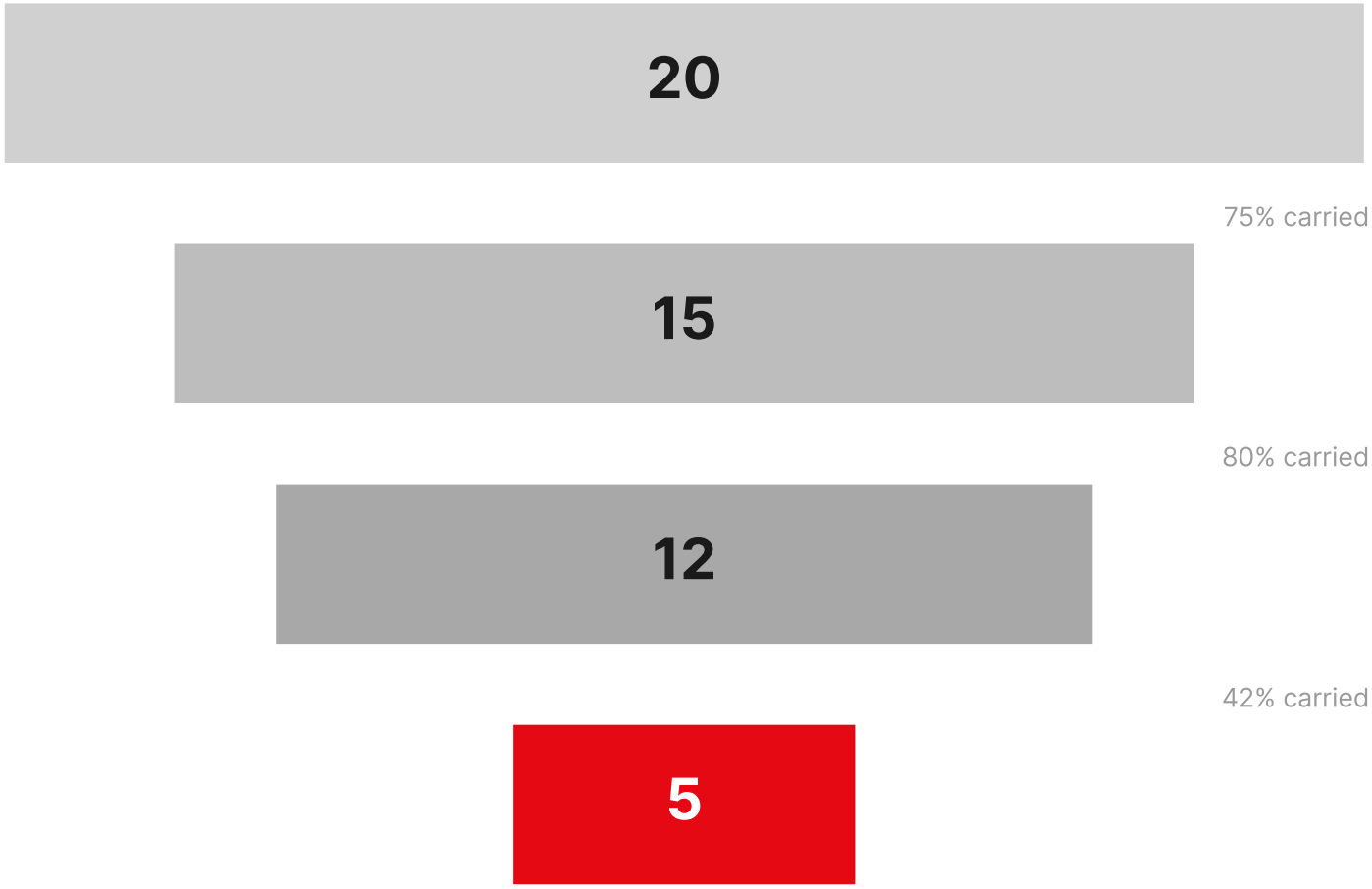
2. Netflix's own screens are the cheapest channel for Binge-Watchers; others need social and influencers.

3. Premium must be felt before it is sold: trials and previews close the subscription gap.

4. Retention depends on habit features: offline, multi-device sync, auto-refreshing playlists.

Twenty ideas narrowed to five MVP features

Idea Funnel: screen for user need, merge overlaps, select for the MVP



Ideas brainstormed

From personas, journeys and market trends

75% carried on

Pass user-need screen

Answers a user need from the research

80% carried on

Refined features

Overlapping ideas merged

42% carried on

Selected for MVP

Unique to Netflix, top pain, or table stakes

Source: report analysis

Every idea traced to a user need, and its outcome

Idea Funnel detail: 5 MVP, 7 later phases, 3 merged, 5 dropped

Idea	Need it addresses	Outcome
Music discovery from Netflix watch history	Binge-Watchers: AI playlists, exclusives	**MVP**
AI-generated personalized playlists	Weak personalization (all segments)	**MVP**
Show soundtrack hubs with exclusive audio	Limited exclusive content	**MVP**
Offline listening	Limited offline access (Casual)	**MVP**
Ad-free premium tier	Too many ads; ad-free motivation	**MVP**
Mood-based playlists	No mood playlists (Casual)	Phase 2
Multi-device sync	No multi-device sync (Regional)	Phase 2
Social sharing and collaborative playlists	Word-of-mouth discovery	Phase 2
Regional hubs with local-language voice search	Not enough regional music	Phase 3
Podcast + music hybrid experience	Netflix and regional podcasts	Phase 3
Karaoke and interactive modes	Karaoke; interactive features	Phase 3
High-fidelity audio	Best audio quality	Phase 4
'Which song was that?' scene recognition	Find music heard in a show	Merged
Voice search for podcasts	Voice search (Regional)	Merged
Smart auto-download	Seamless offline mode	Merged
Live concert streaming	No user asked; very high cost	Dropped
User-uploaded music	No user asked; rights risk	Dropped
Fan remix contests	No user asked	Dropped
Kids' music mode	No persona in the data	Dropped
Episode-release listening parties	Overlaps sharing; low demand	Dropped

Source: report analysis

Netflix Music would lead on exclusives but trail on catalogue

Qualitative rating, 1 (weak) to 5 (strong); analyst judgement as of 2026, not dataset values

	Spotify	Apple Music	Amazon Music	Netflix Music
Catalogue size	5	5	4	2
Personalization	5	4	3	4
Exclusive content	3	3	2	5
Regional content	4	3	3	4
Free tier	5	1	3	4
Ecosystem / bundle	3	5	5	4

Source: report analysis (general market knowledge)

SWOT: strengths in owned IP and data, weakness in licensing

Strategy: use franchises and viewing data to attack discovery and exclusive-content gaps (SO)

STRENGTHS

- Viewing data on hundreds of millions of members
- Owned franchises and their soundtracks
- Proven recommendation engine
- Large subscriber base to cross-sell

WEAKNESSES

- No music licensing deals at launch
- No brand credibility in music yet
- Rivals have years of listening data
- Original audio must be produced

OPPORTUNITIES

- Bundle with Netflix plans to cut churn
- Unmet needs: discovery, regional, mood
- Exclusive audio from hit shows
- Regional markets led by local Originals

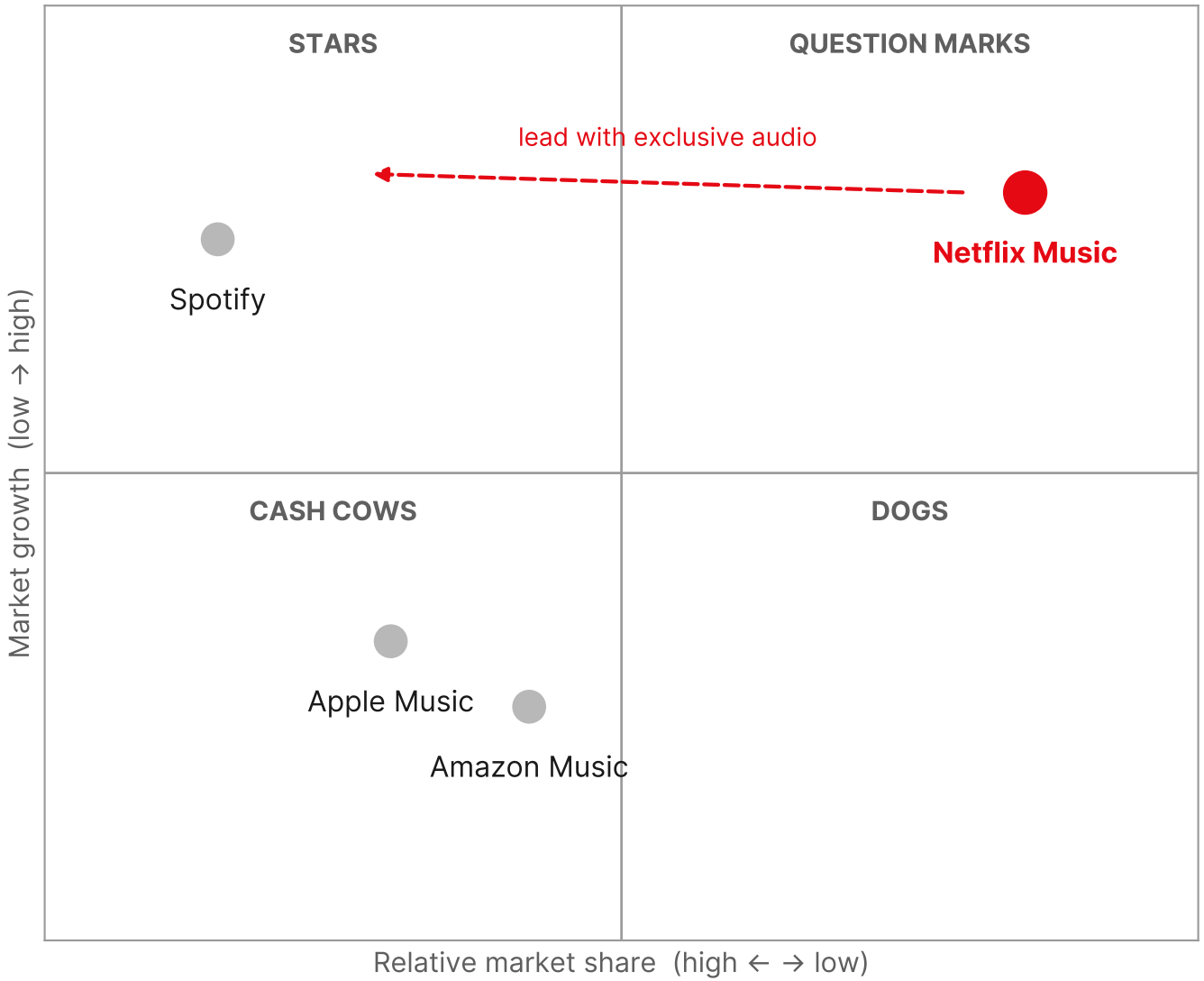
THREATS

- Spotify and Apple can copy features fast
- High royalty costs squeeze margins
- Subscription fatigue
- Privacy concerns over viewing history

Source: report analysis

BCG: Netflix Music starts as a Question Mark; exclusives are the path to Star

Audio streaming market, positions are qualitative (analyst judgement)



Inside Netflix's portfolio

Video streaming — Cash Cow

Fund Netflix Music; cross-promote it on every show page

Netflix Music (overall) — Question Mark

Invest selectively in the MVP; prove retention first

Exclusive audio — Potential Star

Invest heavily: the differentiator rivals cannot copy

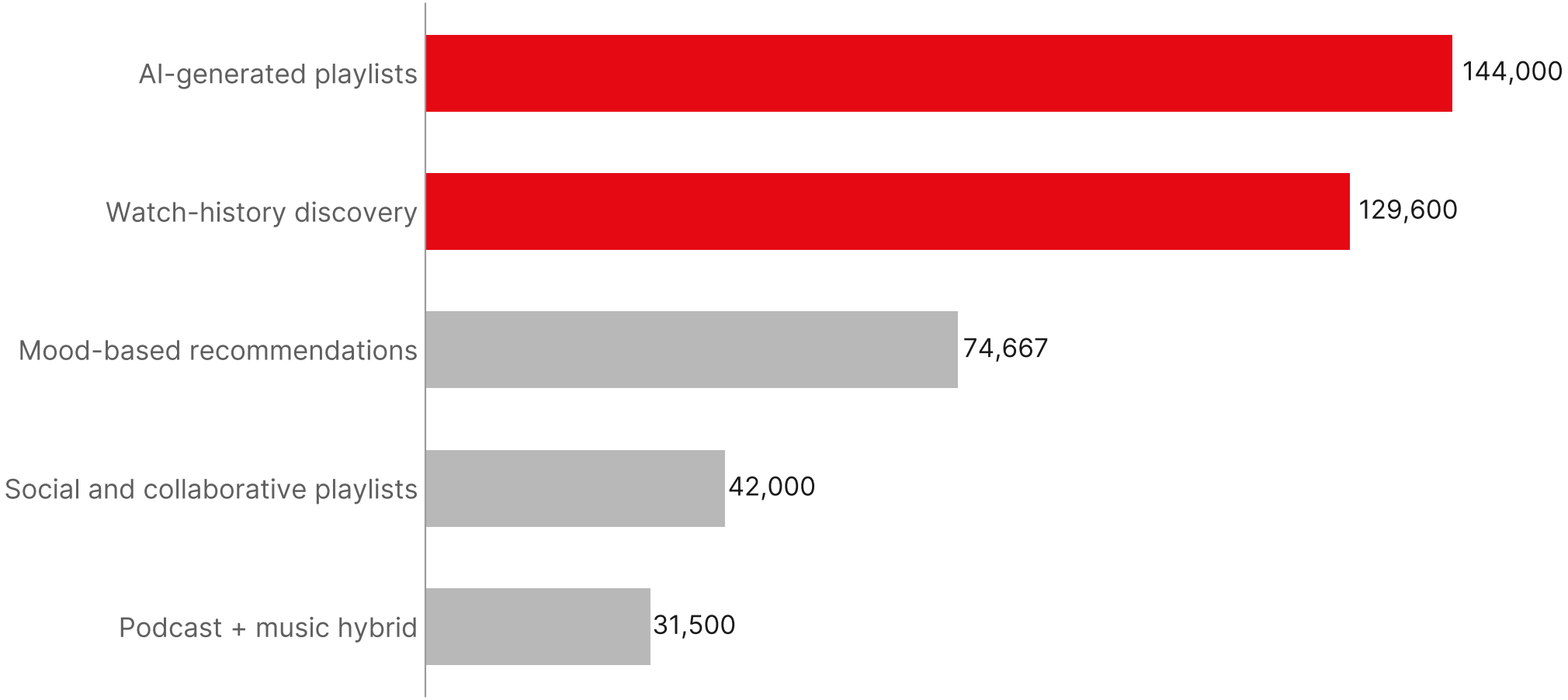
Generic music catalogue — Dog if competed on alone

License only what is needed

Source: report analysis

AI playlists and watch-history discovery lead RICE by about 2x

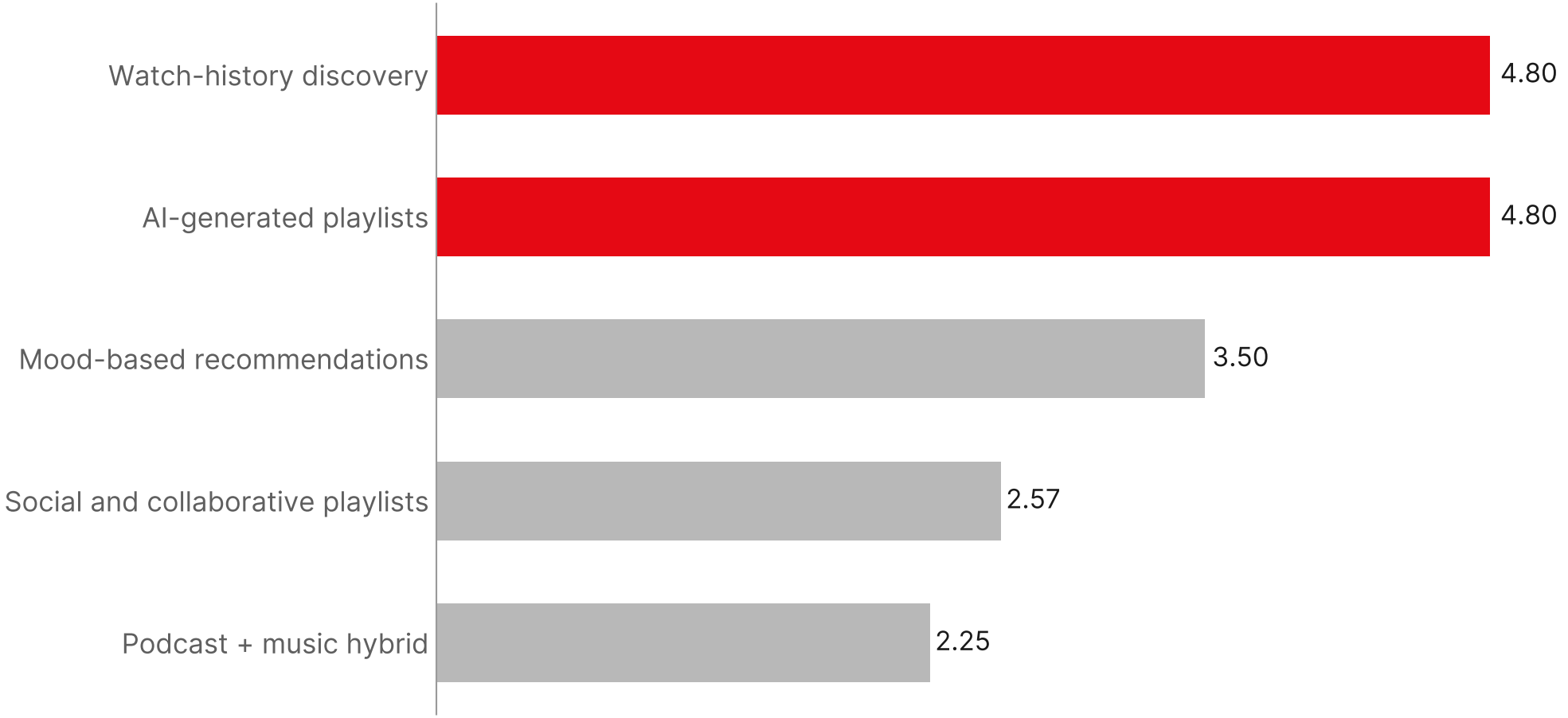
RICE = Reach x Impact x Confidence / Effort



Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

The same two features tie for first on WSJF (4.8)

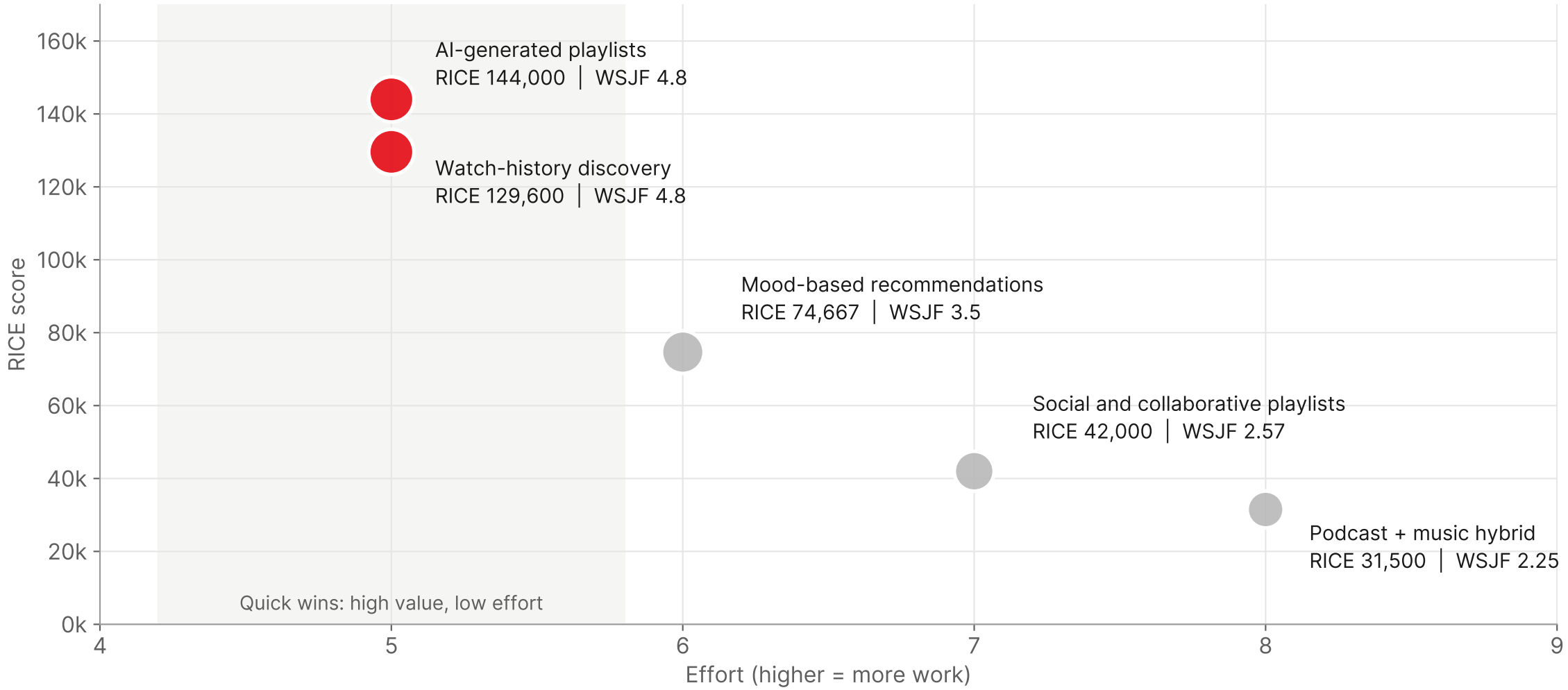
WSJF = (Business Value + Time Criticality + Risk Reduction) / Effort



Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

The MVP features deliver the most value for the least effort

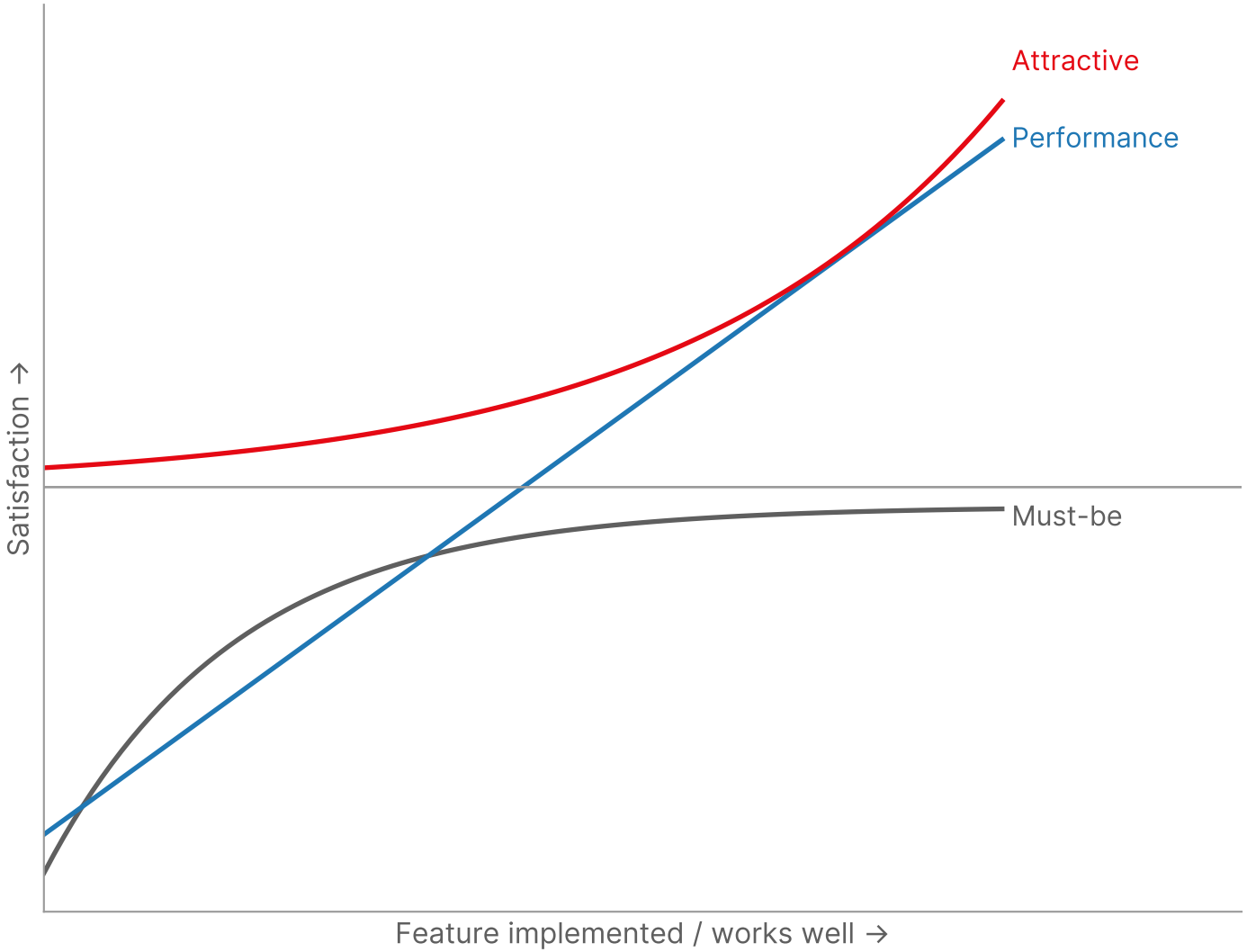
Value vs effort: RICE score against effort; dot size = reach



Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

Kano model: watch-history discovery is the delighter

How each feature affects satisfaction; positions are analyst judgement



ATTRACTIVE

- Watch-history discovery
- Podcast + music hybrid (niche)
- Karaoke mode

PERFORMANCE

- AI-generated playlists
- Mood-based recommendations
- Ad-free, hi-fi audio

MUST-BE

- Basic sharing
- Offline listening
- Multi-device sync

Source: report analysis

All four frameworks agree on the launch order

Combined ranking: RICE and WSJF computed from the dataset; Kano and MoSCoW reasoned from personas and journeys

Rank	Feature	RICE	WSJF	Kano	MoSCoW	Phase
1	AI-Generated Personalized Playlists	144,000 #1	4.8 #1 (tie)	Performance	**Must have**	MVP
2	Music Discovery Based on Netflix Watch History	129,600 #2	4.8 #1 (tie)	Attractive	**Must have**	MVP
3	Mood-Based Music Recommendations	74,667 #3	3.5 #3	Performance	Should have	User Growth
4	Social Sharing and Collaborative Playlists	42,000 #4	2.57 #4	Must-be (basic sharing)	Could have	User Growth
5	Podcast + Music Hybrid Experience	31,500 #5	2.25 #5	Attractive (niche)	Won't have (now)	Differentiation

Source: Netflix_Dataset.xlsx

MVP: every feature answers a defined problem and tests one hypothesis

Problem → MVP feature → hypothesis → success metric

PROBLEM	MVP FEATURE	HYPOTHESIS TO TEST	SUCCESS METRIC
Discovery is generic	**Watch-history discovery + AI daily mix**	If music matches what members watch, they will listen every week	**40% weekly active**
Content is the same everywhere	**Show soundtrack hubs + exclusive audio**	Exclusives give a reason to choose Netflix Music	**30% of listening Netflix-linked**
The story ends at the credits	**'Listen' button after credits + Netflix sign-in**	In-product entry drives trial without paid marketing	**5% of members activate**
Ads and no offline break the habit	**Ad-free premium + offline downloads**	Users will pay to remove friction	**25% free-to-premium**

Source: report analysis

MVP scope: build the core advantage first, defer the rest on purpose

What is in the MVP, what waits, and why

IN THE MVP

- ✓ Music discovery from Netflix watch history
- ✓ AI-generated personalized playlists
- ✓ Show soundtrack hubs with exclusive audio
- ✓ Offline listening
- ✓ Ad-free premium tier

NOT YET, AND WHY

Mood playlists

Casual Listeners are the second wave; ships in User Growth

Regional hubs

Needs regional content deals first

Podcast + music hybrid

Lowest RICE and WSJF, highest effort

Collaborative playlists

No user asked; a share link covers the need

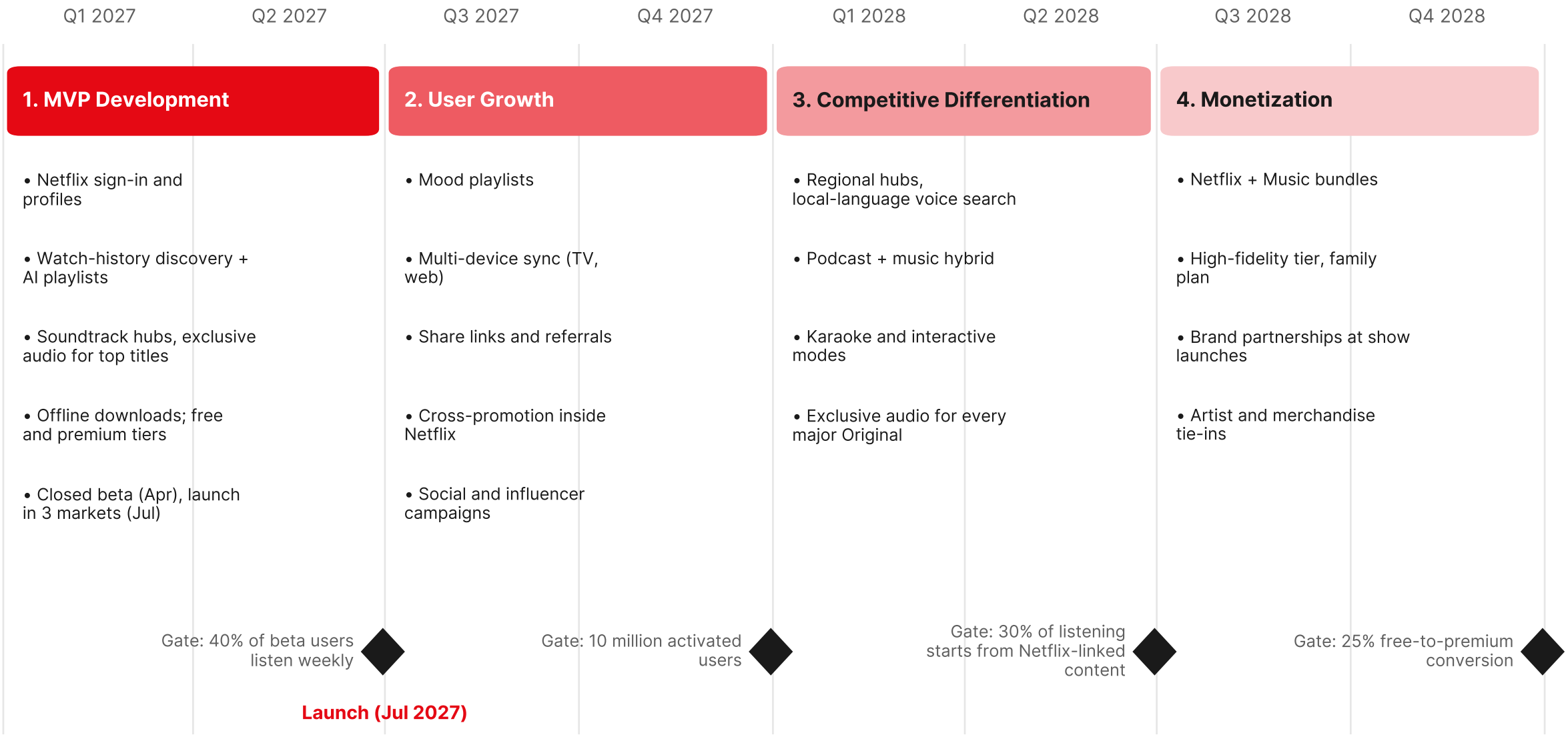
Karaoke, hi-fi audio

Delighters for later; not needed to prove the core

Source: report analysis (RICE/WSJF from the dataset)

Roadmap: MVP in mid-2027, monetization at scale by end of 2028

Four phases with deliverables and the gate each must pass; assumes a January 2027 kickoff



Source: report roadmap (timelines are planning assumptions)

Success metrics and the year-one targets

Targets are planning assumptions, to be validated in the closed beta

ADOPTION	ENGAGEMENT	DIFFERENTIATION	MONETIZATION	RETENTION
5%	**40%**	**30%**	**25%**	**10% lower**
Netflix members who activate Music	Weekly active listeners / activated users	Listening started from a Netflix show or watch-history playlist	Free-to-premium conversion	Churn of Music users vs non-users

Illustrative sizing: 5% of 300M+ members = ~15M users; 25% on a $4.99 add-on = ~3.75M subscribers, about $225M a year before ad revenue and churn savings. All inputs are assumptions.

Source: report analysis